One of the slightly annoying things about adding authentication and authorization to your APIs is that it makes testing harder. You can't just fire a web request from a browser; you must use a tool like Postman that you can add headers to. Even for command-line aficionados, `curl` commands can become unwieldy once you need to add authorization headers. And tokens expire and are typically harder to generate. The list goes on!

I've seen these difficulties lead people to disable authentication requirements for local testing or to try to add them only late in a product's life cycle. I strongly suggest you don't do this! Trying to add real authentication late in a project is likely to cause headaches and bugs that you could easily have caught if you weren't trying to work around the security complexity.

TIP Add real authentication and authorization to your APIs as soon as you understand the requirements, as you will likely catch more security-related bugs.

The user-jwts tool can help significantly with these challenges, as you can easily generate tokens in a format you need, optionally with a long expiration (so you don't need to keep renewing them) without having to wrestle with an identity provider directly. Nevertheless, you need a way to add these tokens to whichever tool you use for testing, such as Swagger UI.

Swagger UI is based on the OpenAPI definition of your API, so the best (and easiest) way to add support for authentication to Swagger UI is to update the security requirements of your application in your OpenAPI document. This consists of two steps:

- Define the security scheme your API uses, such as OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, or simple Bearer authentication.
- Declare which endpoints in your API use the security scheme.